

HARDWARE

Radar



More Info on
the hardware products tested.
Check out
Mindware

Plextor's latest CD-Writer, IBM's TransNote, a CD-ROM drive, a motherboard, a graphics card for great gaming experience and other hardware

Great gaming experience

Best buy for a high-end gaming experience at a normal cost. The card performed well in the tests.

It is capable of delivering a cool 700 million Texel fill rate and has processing capabilities of up to 20 million triangles/second. The heat sink on the card makes it a good buy for the overclocker.

ASUS GeForce2 MX (AGP-V7100)



SPECIFICATIONS:

180 MHz core speed, 166 MHz memory run clock speed

Bundled software: Drivers, ASUS DVD 2000, 3DEEP, Soldier of Fortune

Benchmarks:

Quake III: 102.6 fps (normal mode), 84.3 fps (high quality mode); 31.6 fps (1280x1024) MBTR test: 51.5 fps (640x480 at 16-bit); 50.9 fps (640x480 at 32-bit) 1835 in 3D Mark 2001

verdict

B +

ASUS GeForce2 MX

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Very good performance
+TV out slot
+ Heat sink
Price: Rs.10,500
Contact: Rashi Peripherals
Phone: 022-8260258 **Fax:** 022-8190766
E-mail: kalavr@rptechindia.com
Web site: www.rptechindia.com

Small but spacious

This astonishingly small drive comes with a storage capacity of 1 GB and a compact flash adapter card which it uses to connect to the PCMCIA bay of the laptop. The drive is a blessing, in terms of its storage capacity, for those who use the laptop extensively and need to transfer data to and from a desktop PC.

IBM Microdrive



SPECIFICATIONS:

Interface: PCMCIA
1 GB capacity; compact flash adapter card; 3600 rpm drive spindle speed

Benchmarks:

Drive did not respond in SiSoft Sandra 2001; drive not detected in HDTach due to shortcoming in benchmark 3 minutes 8.75 seconds to copy 100 MB from primary disk; 2 minutes 48.28 seconds to copy to primary disk 3 minutes 7.62 seconds to copy 10x10 MB files from primary hard disk; 2 minutes 44.30 seconds to copy to primary disk

verdict

B +

IBM Microdrive

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Very compact
+1 GB storage capacity
Price: Rs 23,000 + taxes
Contact: Zeta Technology
Phone: 022-4102277
Fax: 022-4100949
E-mail: tejas@zetaindia.com
Web site: www.zetaindia.com

The write thing

This writer comes with the BURN proof technology, which always keeps the buffer full while the CD is being burned. This is especially helpful at high speeds, where even a slight slack in the data flow can damage the CD. Though the writing speed has been improved majorly, the erasing speed is average.

Plextor Plexwriter 16/10/40 PX-1610TAW



SPECIFICATIONS:

BURN proof technology

Features: fan at the back chassis to keep the internal drive electronics, motor and head cool

Bundled software: included AHEAD Nero 5 CD-Burning software

Benchmarks:

19 minutes 42 seconds to erase/write 650 MB of data; 1250 in CD-Winbench 99, 586 KBps random read, 134 ms average access time SiSoft Sandra: 19 minutes 45 seconds at 4x; 6 minutes 51 seconds at 12x

verdict

B +

Plextor Plexwriter

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Very fast
+ Nero CD burning software included
- Average file copy speed
Price: Rs 13,950 + taxes
Contact: Zeta Technologies
Phone: 022-4102277 **Fax:** 022-4100949
E-mail: tejas@zetaindia.com
Web site: www.zetaindia.com